

Nina Passes

The vet's room is small and quiet. Andrea puts Nina's carrier on the table. Nina looks out with big eyes.

The vet picks up Nina's papers. She reads the vaccination certificate. Then she takes a small scanner. She scans Nina's microchip.

"Nina is healthy," the vet says. "Everything is correct."

Andrea feels her shoulders relax.

The immigration officer comes back into the room. He looks at his papers. Then he takes Andrea's passport. He takes a stamp.

"Welcome to the United Kingdom," he says. He almost smiles.

Andrea smiles back. "Thank you," she says.

She goes to collect her bags. They are very heavy. She pulls one bag. She pushes the other. Nina's carrier is in her hand.

A kind man sees her. "Can I help?" he asks.

"Yes, please!" Andrea says. She laughs.

Together, they walk to the big doors. The doors open.

Andrea walks into the arrivals hall. She sees many people. She looks left. She looks right. Then she sees him. Her husband.

He runs to her. He hugs her. He looks at Nina.

"Hello, Nina," he says softly. Nina makes a small sound.

Andrea laughs and cries at the same time. They are together. They are home.